

THE 2-HOUR JOB SEARCH

Steve Dalton

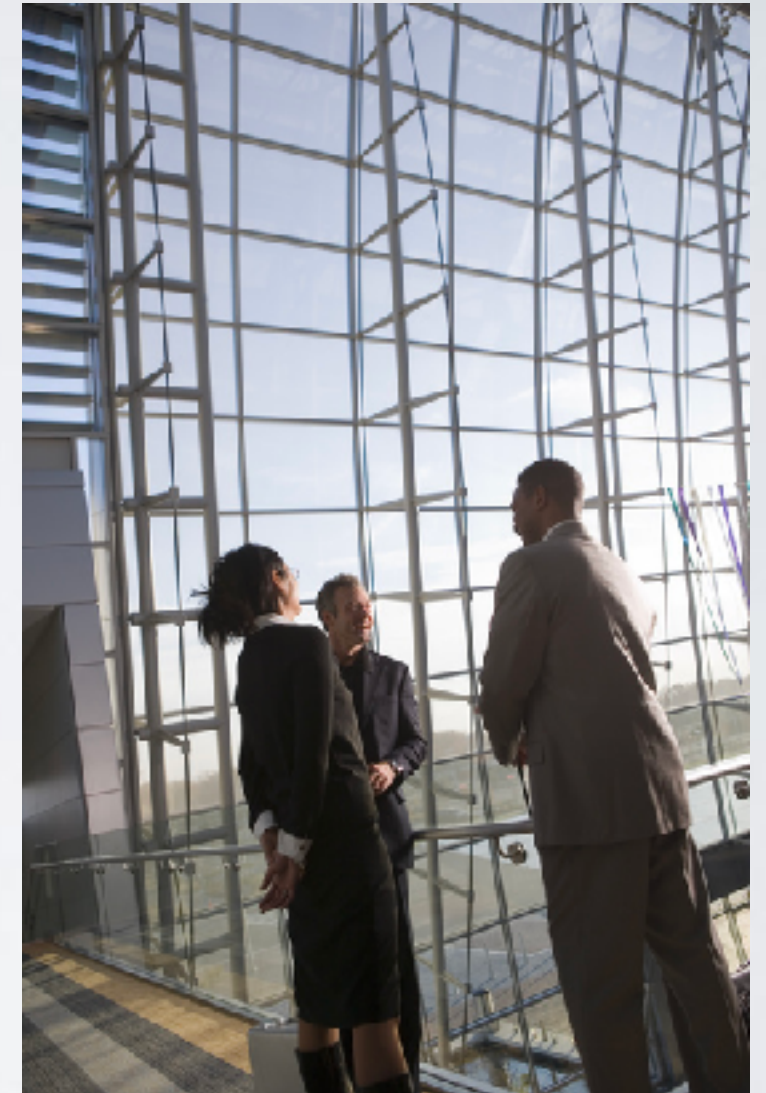
Author of The 2-Hour Job Search & The Job Closer

Founder & CEO of Contact2Colleague

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Identify and prioritize target employers in an efficient and strategic manner
- Understand how to comfortably and effectively request time & knowledge from strangers
- Conduct informational meetings that maximize odds of converting a contact into a colleague

TIPS OR INSTRUCTIONS?



**Instructions help more people get good results faster —
consider this one effective, *precise* recipe**

MODERN JOB SEARCHING (IN A SINGLE STATISTIC)

- **QUIZ:** For each hire found from an online posting app, ? were found from internal referrals?
 - So to get interviews, we must get referrals...
 - ...and to get referrals, we must turn strangers into advocates



Note: application referrals are not the equivalent of human referrals

SO HOW *EXACTLY* DO WE GET INTERVIEWS?

- Networking! 💩
 - “Using informational meetings to get interview referrals from strangers”
 - Different than *reactive* networking
- **My** recipe for the first **two hours**
 - Penguin Random House ('12, '20)
 - Used at >100 schools worldwide



**Focus on learning, get job leads;
focus on job leads, get neither**

2HJS splits networking into its three component parts

1. Prioritize employers

2. Contact employees

3. Convince advocates

Please ask questions

THE 2-HOUR JOB SEARCH

Using Technology to Get
the Right Job *FASTER*



STEVE DALTON

Senior Career Consultant and Associate Director,
Duke University's Fuqua School of Business

SECOND
EDITION



Good game theory



No game theory

Expand consideration set to avoid artificial desperation

LAMP LIST

- LAMP List makes you The Bachelor of your search in 70 min

#	List	Alumni	Motivation	Posting
1				
2				
3				
4				
5				
6				
7				
8				
9				
10				
11				
12				
13				
14				
15				
...				
40				

Use 80-20 Rule to find 40 **custom** targets, then 3 predictive data points

LIST COLUMN = 40 POSSIBILITIES IN 40 MINUTES

Four brainstorm techniques x 10
min each:

- 1) Dream sector
- 2) Alumni
- 3) Indeed
- 4) Trending

Do not make multiple LAMP lists

#	List
1	Leapfrog
2	Tivo
3	Enspire
4	Teach Street
5	Scholastic
6	
7	
8	
9	
10	



COLLECT 3 PIECES OF DATA

#	List	Alumni	Motivation	Posting
1	PlayFirst			
2	Udemy			
3	BetterUp			
4	Duolingo			
5	Broderbund			
6	2tor			
7	Simplilearn			
8	TeachStreet			
9	Coursera			
10	Grockit			
11	Inkling Games			
12	Tivo			
13	Kaboose			
14	frog design			
15	Udacity			
...	...			
40	Udemy			

COLLECT 3 PIECES OF DATA

- Alumni = familiarity with brand & cost to hire you (10 min)

#	List	Alumni	Motivation	Posting
1	PlayFirst	Y		
2	Udemy	N		
3	BetterUp	Y		
4	Duolingo	N		
5	Broderbund			
6	2tor	N		
7	Simplilearn			
8	TeachStreet	N		
9	Coursera	N		
10	Grockit	N		
11	Inkling Games	N		
12	Tivo	N		
13	Kaboose			
14	frog design	N		
15	Udacity	N		
...	...	...		
40	Udemy	N		

COLLECT 3 PIECES OF DATA

- Motivation = ability to keep going when ignored (5 min)

#	List	Alumni	Motivation	Posting
1	PlayFirst	Y	3	
2	Udemy	N	1	
3	BetterUp	Y	0	
4	Duolingo	N	1	
5	Broderbund	Y	3	
6	2tor	N	3	
7	Simplilearn	N	2	
8	TeachStreet	N	3	
9	Coursera	N	2	
10	Grockit	N	3	
11	Inkling Games	Y	2	
12	Tivo	N	3	
13	Kaboose	Y	3	
14	frog design	N	3	
15	Udacity	N	2	
...	...	...	...	
40	Udemy	N	0	

COLLECT 3 PIECES OF DATA

- Posting = urgency of finding an advocate if interested (15 min)

#	List	Alumni	Motivation	Posting
1	PlayFirst	Y	3	2
2	Udemy	N	1	3
3	BetterUp	Y	0	1
4	Duolingo	N	1	2
5	Broderbund	Y	3	3
6	2tor	N	3	2
7	Simplilearn	N	2	1
8	TeachStreet	N	3	2
9	Coursera	N	2	2
10	Grockit	N	3	1
11	Inkling Games	Y	2	3
12	Tivo	N	3	3
13	Kaboose	Y	3	1
14	frog design	N	3	3
15	Udacity	N	2	1
...	...	...	...	...
40	Udemy	N	0	2

SORT BY M, P, THEN A TO ID TOP 6

- After 1st sort, use intuition (by changing M scores) to pick Top 6

#	List	Alumni	Motivation	Posting
1	PlayPower	Y	3	3
2	Broderbund	Y	3	3
3	Club Penguin	Y	3	3
4	Tivo	N	3	3
5	frog design	N	3	3
6	Inst. of Play	Y	3	2
7	PlayFirst	Y	3	2
8	2tor	N	3	2
9	TeachStreet	N	3	2
10	Screen Life	Y	3	1
11	Kaboose	Y	3	1
12	ZipCar	N	3	1
13	Grockit	N	3	1
14	Inkling Games	Y	2	3
15	InVisM	N	2	3
...	...	...	...	...
40	Enspire Learning	N	0	3

SORT BY M, P, THEN A TO ID TOP 6

- After 1st sort, change 6 employers' M scores to 4 for *real* Top 6

#	List	Alumni	Motivation	Posting
1	PlayPower	Y	4	3
2	Broderbund	Y	4	3
3	Club Penguin	Y	4	3
4	Tivo	N	4	3
5	frog design	N	4	3
6	Inst. of Play	Y	4	2
7	PlayFirst	Y	3	2
8	2tor	N	3	2
9	TeachStreet	N	3	2
10	Screen Life	Y	3	1
11	Kaboose	Y	3	1
12	ZipCar	N	3	1
13	Grockit	N	3	1
14	Inkling Games	Y	2	3
15	InVisM	N	2	3
...	...	...	...	...
40	Enspire Learning	N	0	3

STEP 1: PRIORITIZE RECAP

1. Be The Bachelor, not one of masses over and over again
2. Use the 80-20 rule
3. Start with data, finish with intuition

Result: We have identified our top 6 employers, whom we will initiate outreach to simultaneously in Step 2: Contact

Quiz: What is the correct sort order of a LAMP list?

2HJS splits getting interviews into three distinct “bites”

1. Prioritize employers

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SECOND
EDITION

WHAT IF CONTACTS DON'T RESPOND?

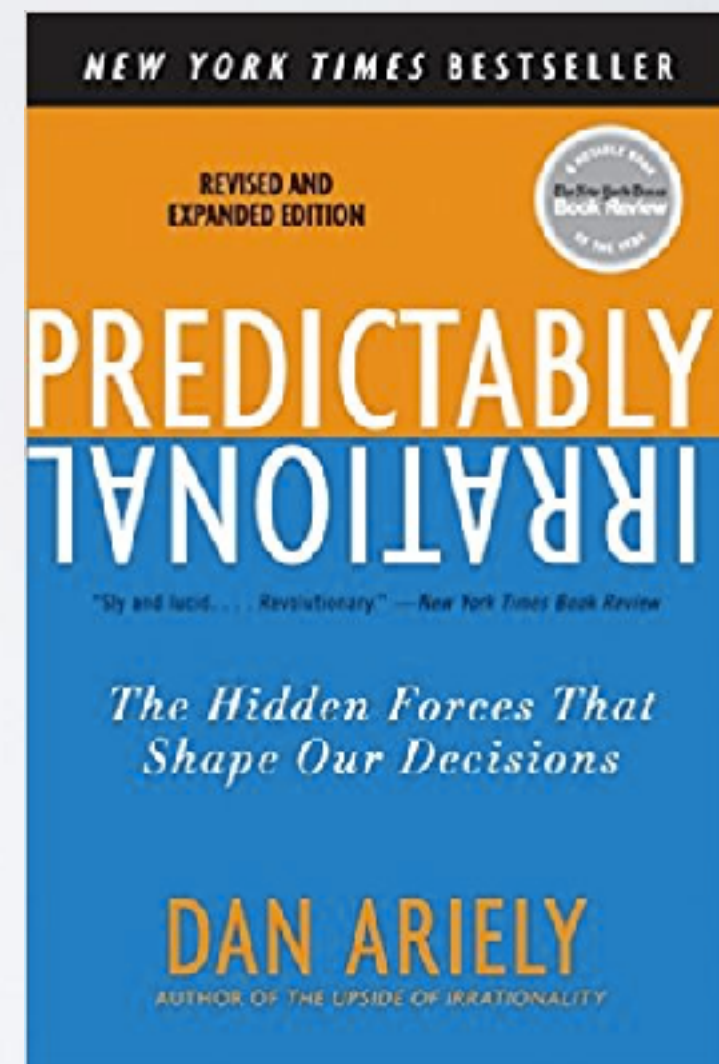
- Three types of contacts you'll encounter
 - Curmudgeons
 - Obligates
 - Boosters
- Unfortunately...



Poll: Best predictor of who will be a Booster?

HOW DO WE GET BOOSTERS ON THE PHONE / ZOOM?

- Sell yourself?
 - Thought exercise
- Dan Ariely's work offers another way
 - Thought exercise #2



ORIGINAL 6-POINT E-MAIL

Subject: Your product management experience at Waymo

Hi Jeff,

I'm Becca, a fellow Duke MBA ('24). May I chat with you briefly about your product management experience at Waymo?

I am trying to learn more about product management in the autonomous vehicle space, so your insights would be greatly appreciated.

Best regards,
Becca

6-POINT E-MAIL RULES

1. **BRIEF:** Short (<75 words)
2. **HUMAN:** Connection goes first
3. **SUBTLE:** Request advice & insight, not job assistance
4. **DIRECT:** Make your ask in the form of a question (ending in “?”)
5. **EGOLESS:** Over half of word count is about contact, not you (also: no resumes or “about me”)
6. **SINCERE:** Define interest narrowly (Waymo) **and broadly** (“autonomous vehicle space”)

WHAT IF I'M AN EXPERIENCED PROFESSIONAL?

Subject: Your finance experience at Reebok

Hi Jin,

My name is Jane and I'm a fellow member of LinkedIn's Sports Apparel Group. May I have a few minutes to ask you about your experience with Reebok?

I have spent the last several years in finance at Nike and am now seeking to return to Boston to be closer to family.

Thank you,
Jane Ray

3B7 REDUCES ANXIETY

Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday
1st try, 1st contact	2	3	3B: 1st try, 2nd contact*	5
8	9	7B: 2nd try, 1st contact*	11	12
15	16	17	18	19
22	23	24	25	26

- Email favorite contact at 2 employers for three consecutive days to start
- Pause additional outreach if contact replies (www.tinyurl.com/2HJS3b7)

* If necessary

STEP 2: CONTACT RECAP

1. Choose contacts that are **functionally-relevant** above all else
2. Target Boosters (but expect Obligates & Curmudgeons)
3. Treat this process probabilistically

Result: **Two hours** of effort results in one or more informational w/ Top 6 employer(s)

Quiz: At least what % of your 6-Point Email's word count should be about the recipient?

2HJS splits getting interviews into three distinct “bites”

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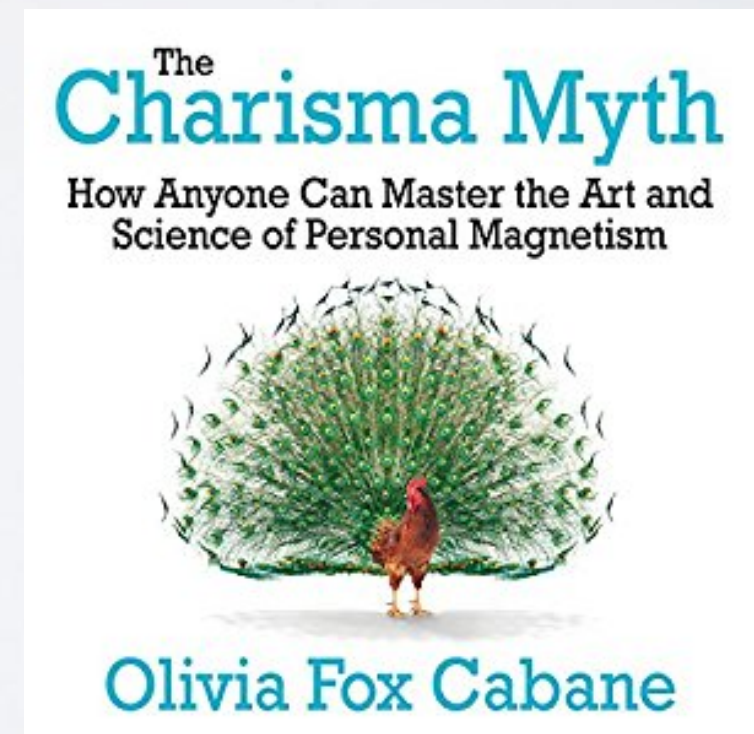
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SECOND
EDITION

HOW *EXACTLY* DO YOU DO INFORMATIONALS?

- Don't “sell yourself” — it's outdated & counterproductive
- Alternative is to be likable, which *anyone* can do
 - Likability is driven by how well you *listen*, not speak



INFORMATIONALS ARE PREDICTABLE

- Three basic elements in an informational
 - Small talk (tinyurl.com/2hjsSmallTalk)
 - Q&A
 - Next steps
- **Goal is to get an internal referral**



Q&A “JOURNEY” USING TIARA FRAMEWORK (15-20 MIN)

- **T**rends
- **I**nsights
- **A**dvice
- **R**esources
- **A**ssignments

Expert



Mentor

Ask questions that are a) flattering and b) fun to answer

TIARA QUESTION EXAMPLES

- **Trends:** “What trend is most impacting your space right now?”
- **Insights:** “What surprises you most about your work?”
- **Advice:** “What do you know now that you wish you knew as a student?”
- **Resources:** “What resources do you recommend I look into next?”
- **Assignments:** “*What’s been your favorite project so far, and why?*”

Q&A: TIARA COMMENTS

- Try to ask just one question per TIARA topic
 - However, ask at least one follow-up question per TIARA question to show engagement & validate their answers
- To buy time, have a list of conversation “extenders” ready
 - “That’s interesting - can you elaborate?”
 - “Please tell me more...”
 - “That’s surprising!”
 - “Can you go into more detail on that?”

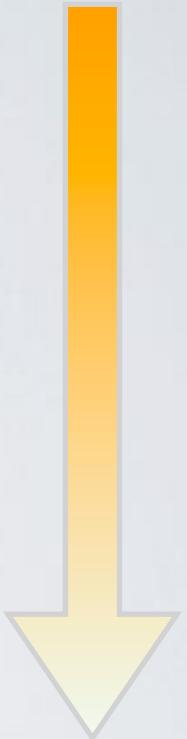
NEXT STEPS (<5 MIN)

- If you get a referral, promise an update in two weeks
- If not, at end of informational say:
 - “You’ve given me a lot to think about. I’m going to take the weekend to reflect. Is it OK if I reach back out to you with any additional questions I might have?” & set reminder for one week later
 - Then one week later write: “Thanks again for your time last week. Upon further reflection this is definitely something I’d like to pursue further. How would you do so if you were me? For example, can you recommend someone I should speak to next?”
- Send (ask-less) thank you note within 24 hrs either way

KEEP 6 ORGS ACTIVE AT ONCE

- Only move to #7 **after** you find closure at one of #1-6

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3	Club Penguin	Y	3	3
4	Tivo	N	3	3
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7	PlayFirst	Y	3	2
8	2tor	N	3	2
9	TeachStreet	N	3	2
10	Screen Life	Y	3	1
11	Kaboose	Y	3	1
12	ZipCar	N	3	1
13	Grockit	N	3	1
14	Inkling Games	Y	2	3
15	InVisM	N	2	3
...	...	...	...	...
40	Enspire Learning	N	0	3



STEP 3: RECRUIT RECAP

1. Be likable; don't sell yourself
2. Ask re-usable questions that are flattering & fun to answer
3. **Get the referral** by email a week later (if one is not offered during the call itself)

Result: Odds of success steadily increase with each conversation

2-HOUR JOB SEARCH RECAP

1. PRIORITIZE (LAMP):
2. CONTACT (6-Point Email; 3B7):
3. RECRUIT (TIARA):
4. Fishing for lobster, not fish
5. You are learning to play the violin

Be the Bachelor

Be probabilistic

Be likable



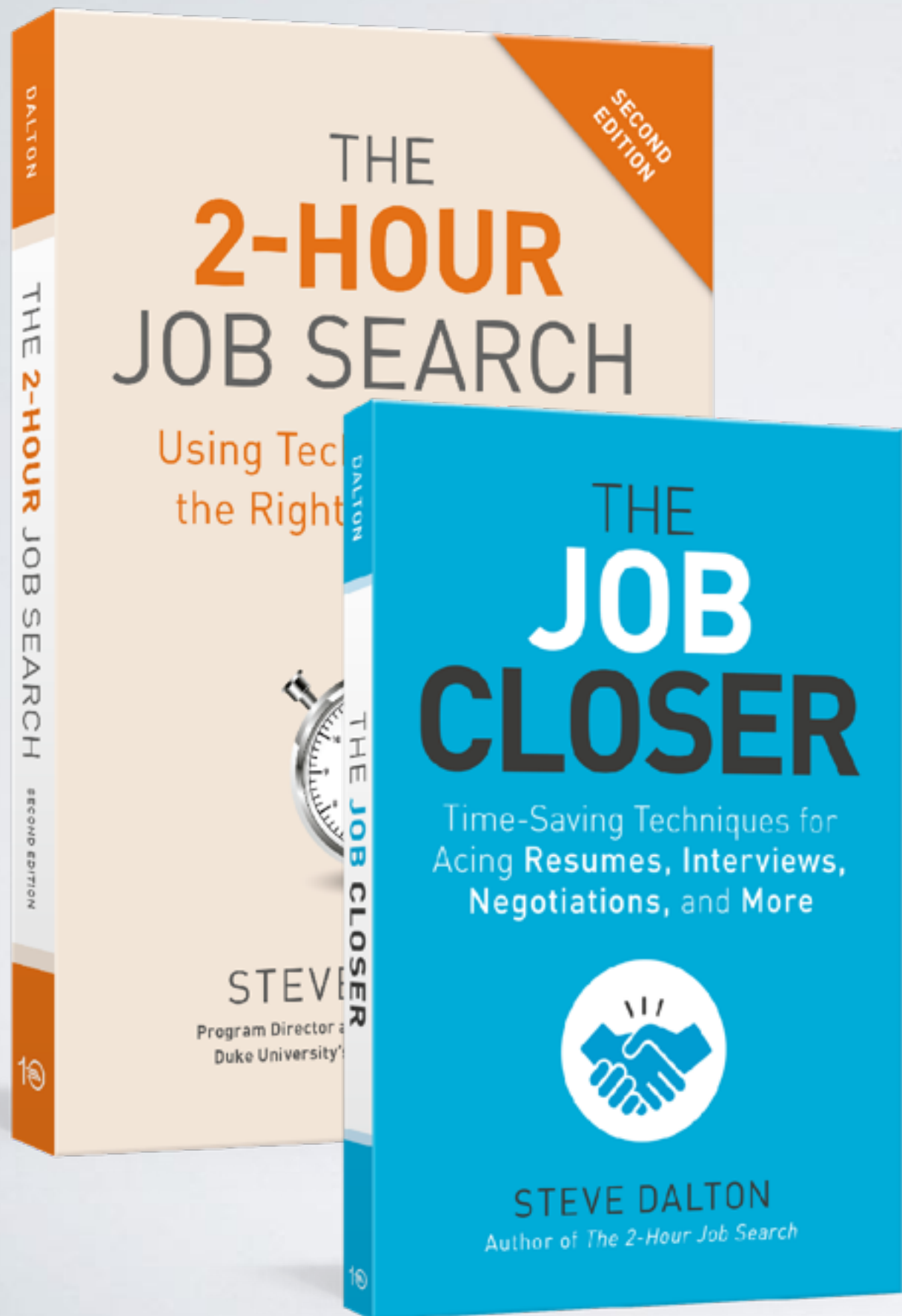
2-HOUR JOB SEARCH FINAL EXAM

2-HOUR JOB SEARCH FINAL EXAM

1. PRIORITIZE (LAMP): **What is the minimum number of employers necessary to create a LAMP list?**
2. CONTACT (6-Point Email; 3B7): **You'll encounter Boosters, Obligates, & _____?**
3. RECRUIT (TIARA): **When's the best time to ask for a networking referral from an informational?**

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Identify and prioritize target employers in an efficient and strategic manner
- Understand how to comfortably and effectively request time & knowledge from strangers
- Conduct informational meetings that maximize odds of converting a contact into a colleague



THANK YOU

KEEP IN TOUCH!

LI Group: **The 2-Hour Job Search & The Job Closer - Q&A Forum**

Twitter: **@Dalton_Steve**

Please tell your friends and family

Check out *The Job Closer* for more recipes!